

Four Drafting Steps



Eight-Step Translation Method

Drafting Steps

- Consume
- Verbalize
- Chunk
- Blind Draft



Checking Steps

- Self-edit
- Peer-edit
- Key Word Check
- Verse-by-Verse Check



Alone

Step 1: Consume

5–7
minutes



How sweet are your words to my taste, yes, sweeter than honey to my mouth!
Psalm 119:103

Process: 1. Read the passage in the source text
2. Think about the meaning of the passage

Benefits: • Understand the overview and main points
• Get the passage into your short-term memory

Tip: Highlighting or underlining in this step is good, but any deeper note-taking interrupts your thought flow and short-term memory.



With a partner, or alone

Step 2: Verbalize



2-3
minutes

With my mouth I have declared all the righteous decrees that you have revealed.
Psalm 119:13

Process: Speak out loud in your own language what you just read

Benefits:

- Your mind begins to process and sort the information
- The passage moves into your working memory; you remember more

Tips: Always speak the passage out loud, even if you have no partner to listen. Try to remember the main points and summarize the passage.



Alone

Step 3: Chunk

5–7
minutes



Open my eyes so that I may see marvelous things in your law.

Psalms 119:18

Process: Divide the passage into smaller parts

Benefits:

- Your mind has to categorize and analyze the information
- You recognize the flow of the passage
- The passage is now moving into your long-term memory

Tips: Divide the passage at natural transitions or topic breaks.
Make your chunks small enough to easily remember the main points,
but long enough that you cannot memorize the text.



Alone

Step 4: Blind Draft



No
time limit

I have stored up your word in my heart so that I might not sin against you. Blessed you are, Yahweh; teach me your statutes. Psalm 119:11-12

- Process:
1. Re-read the first chunk in your source text
 2. Close the source text and draft the first chunk in your heart
language without looking back
 3. Repeat for each chunk

- Benefits:
- Free your mind from the words and structure of the source language
 - Draft a natural sounding translation
 - Focus on re-stating the meaning (not the wording)

Tips: Skip a line between each line of your draft to leave room for corrections.
Don't worry about marking verse numbers for now.
Don't worry if you forget something. This is only your first draft!

Drafting Steps Summarized

1

Consume

Think about
what the
passage means



5–7 min.

2

Verbalize

Summarize
the passage out
loud in your
language



2–3 min.

3

Chunk

Break the passage
down into smaller
pieces based on
meaning

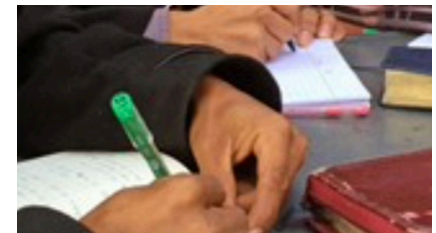


1–4 verses

4

Blind Draft

Draft
each chunk
from memory



no source text



Try it

Are you surprised by what you can do?

What is difficult?

Are you ready for the next steps?



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